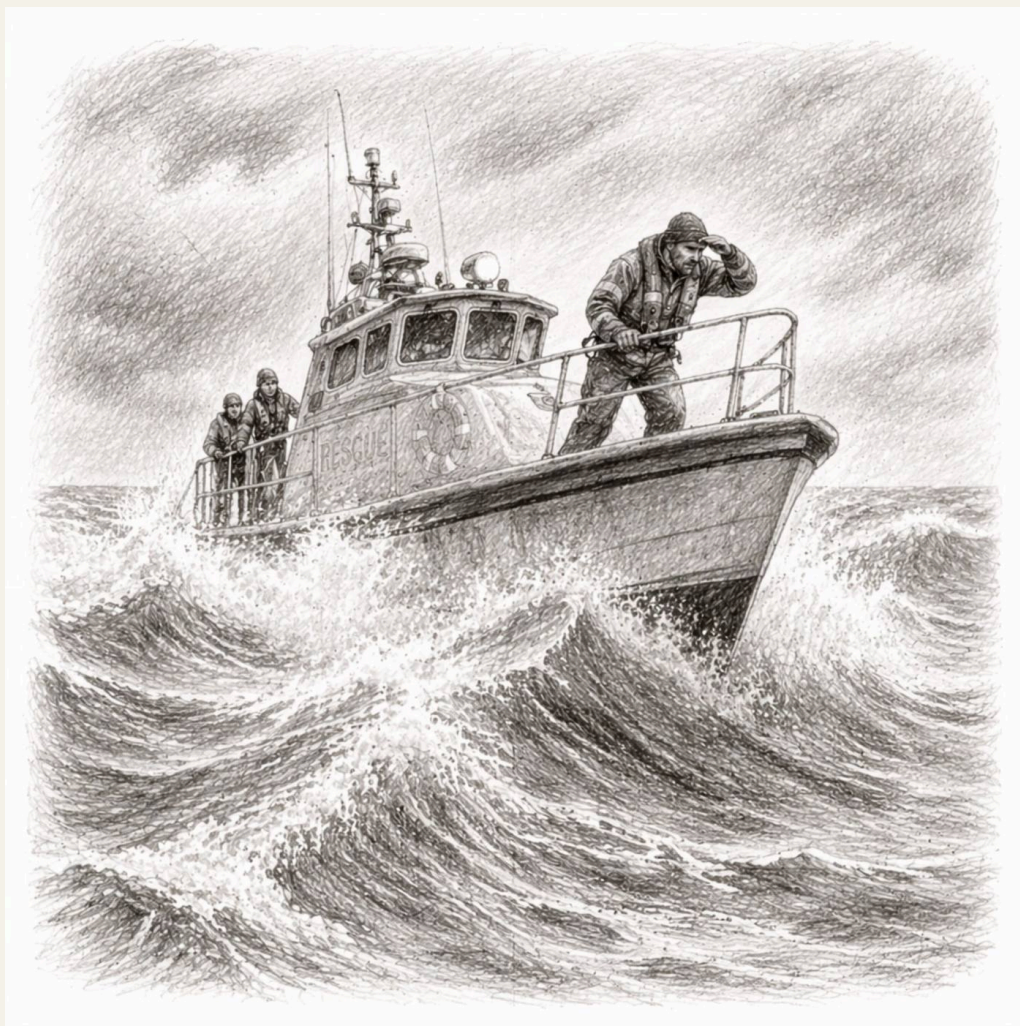


Salvation



A rescue boat climbs a wave that could bury it. The hull says RESCUE. The crew is already in the weather. Nobody on deck is lecturing the drowning about their stroke.

Before you gather

- Read Day 12, Salvation, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Exodus 14:13–14, 30–31 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.

- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.
- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

When have you been lost — a store as a child, a trail, a parking garage, a city — and had to be found? What did your body do when you realized someone was coming?

Leader. Relief is physical. You are after that feeling, not a spiritual autobiography. The book already asked what they were drowning in. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Salvation is not coaching. The boat comes into the sea you cannot survive. God rescues. We are not the crew that saved ourselves and then offered God a ride.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Salvation is the gracious and sovereign act of God in which He rescues sinners from sin and judgment through faith in Jesus Christ, restores them to fellowship with Himself, and grants them eternal life by the power of His Spirit.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek *sōtēria* — salvation, deliverance, safety, being brought out.

MEMORY VERSE · ROMANS 1:16

For I am not ashamed of the gospel, for it is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes, to the Jew first and also to the Greek.

Together, open the flashcard for Salvation. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Exodus 14:13–14, 30–31

Psalm 18 was the devotion's mirror passage. Exodus 14 is the church's basic picture of salvation: an enemy, a sea, a God who fights, a people who did not part the water.

And Moses said to the people, "Fear not, stand firm, and see the salvation of the LORD, which he will work for you today. For the Egyptians whom you see today, you shall never see again. The LORD will fight for you, and you have only to be silent." Thus the LORD saved Israel that day from the hand of the Egyptians... and Israel saw the great power that the LORD used against the Egyptians, so the people feared the LORD, and they believed in the LORD and in his servant Moses.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. What are the people told to do? Who does the saving? CORE

Leader. Fear not, stand firm, see, be silent. The Lord saves. Their assignment is trust, not technique.

2. Verse 31 says that after they saw, they feared and believed. What came first in the story — their faith, or God's act?

Leader. God acted, they saw, then they believed. Faith receives a salvation already worked. Do not turn this into a full ordo debate.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. What are the “swim harder” versions of Christianity we still preach to ourselves and to our kids? CORE

Leader. Try harder, feel more, serve more, as if those were the motor. They are fruit. The sea was opened by God.

4. Scripture speaks of salvation as past (Ephesians 2:8), present (1 Corinthians 1:18, “being saved”), and future (Romans 13:11). Which tense do you forget, and what does that forgetfulness do to you?

Leader. Only past: no growth. Only present: no assurance. Only future: no joy now. Most of us drop one.

5. The crew went into the storm for people who could not save themselves. Who around you is still in the water, and what would it mean to point them to Christ instead of coaching their swimming?

Leader. A name, a next step: a meal, an invitation, a clear sentence. Not a project to fix them.

5 · SAY IT · 5 MIN

In one sentence

Salvation is God rescuing us from sin and judgment through Jesus, not us escaping on our own.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 · THIS WEEK · 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Ask someone who does not follow Jesus what they are counting on when life falls apart. Listen. Tell them salvation is God rescuing people through Jesus, not us climbing out. Offer one practical help you can actually give — a ride, a meal, a night of childcare — and call it a small picture, not the rescue.

Leader. Keep the help smaller than the Savior. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Leave silence between these

1. Thank God for a rescue you did not engineer.
2. Be silent for a few seconds, on purpose, as Exodus 14:14 says.
3. Pray for someone still in the water.

Before you stumble

Some believers have no cinematic testimony. The Exodus generation included complainers who were still brought through. Do not rank stories. Faith rests on Christ's work. Also: "you have only to be silent" is not an excuse to ignore God's commands. It is the opposite of self-rescue in the moment of salvation.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what advice adults give that sounds like swimming lessons for a drowning person. Let them be honest. Then ask what the boat actually is.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Jonah 2:9, "Salvation belongs to the LORD." One line, worth memorizing beside Romans 1:16.